



Prompting 101

How to Talk to AI — for Complete Beginners

What is a prompt?

The magic formula

Good vs Bad prompts

Pro tips

No coding. No jargon. Just better conversations with AI.

6 slides · Beginner-friendly

What is a Prompt?

A prompt is simply the message you type to an AI.

Think of it like giving instructions to a very smart assistant who does exactly what you ask — no more, no less.



Search engine

You type keywords and hope for the best.

"python tutorial"



A prompt

You have a full conversation with clear instructions.

"Explain Python loops to a 10-year-old, with examples."



Think of it like...

Ordering at a restaurant.

The more detail you give the chef, the better your meal!

The Magic Formula ✨

Great prompts follow a simple 4-part structure:

1

Role

Tell the AI who to be

"You are a friendly cooking teacher..."

2

Task

What do you want it to do?

"...explain how to boil an egg..."

3

Context

Give background information

"...to someone who has never cooked before..."

4

Format

How should the answer look?

"...in 5 simple steps with emojis."

Combined: "You are a friendly cooking teacher. Explain how to boil an egg to someone who has never cooked before, in 5 simple steps with emojis."

Good Prompts vs Bad Prompts



Weak Prompt

"Tell me about health."

Too vague — AI has to guess what you want

"Write something."

Too vague — AI has to guess what you want

"Help me with Python."

Too vague — AI has to guess what you want

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Strong Prompt

"Explain 3 simple daily habits that improve mental health for a busy parent, in plain English."

Specific role, task, context, and format

"Write a 3-sentence birthday message for my 8-year-old nephew who loves dinosaurs. Keep it fun and silly."

Specific role, task, context, and format

"I'm a beginner. Explain Python for-loops using a real-world example, then give me a practice exercise."

Specific role, task, context, and format

The more specific your prompt, the better and more useful the AI's answer will be.

Real-World Examples

Here are 3 ready-to-use prompts you can try right now:



Write a professional email

Why it works: Specifies role + tone + length + ending

"You are a professional business writer. Write a polite follow-up email to a client who hasn't responded to my proposal in 2 weeks. Keep it under 100 words and end with a clear call to action."



Learn a new concept

Why it works: Sets skill level + bans jargon + adds quiz

"I'm a complete beginner. Explain what machine learning is using only everyday analogies. No technical terms. Give me 3 examples from daily life, then a 2-question quiz at the end."



Plan a weekly meal

Why it works: Role + constraint + format + family context

"Act as a nutritionist. Create a 5-day dinner plan for a family of 4 with one vegetarian. Each meal should take under 30 minutes to prepare. Show it as a simple table with ingredients listed."

Copy any of these, swap in your own details, and you're ready to go! ✨

Pro Tips & Common Mistakes ⚡

✓ Tips that work



Iterate & refine

Not happy with the answer? Say "Make it shorter" or "Make it funnier" and keep improving.



Set a length

Say "in 3 bullet points" or "in under 100 words" to avoid walls of text.



Assign a role

"Act as a doctor / lawyer / chef" primes the AI to use the right tone and knowledge.



Use examples

Show the AI what you want: "Write in this style: [paste example]"



Say what NOT to do

"Don't use jargon", "Don't include prices", "Avoid bullet points".

✗ Mistakes to avoid



Being too vague

"Help me" tells the AI nothing. Always say WHAT you need and WHY.



One giant question

Break complex tasks into smaller prompts. AI works better step-by-step.



Giving up too fast

If the first answer isn't great, refine your prompt — don't start over.



No context at all

"Rewrite this" — what is "this"? Always paste the content you're referring to.



Expecting perfection

AI is a first draft machine, not a finished product. Always review its output.

Your Prompting Cheat Sheet



1

The Formula

Role + Task + Context + Format
= a great prompt every time

2

Be Specific

"Write a 50-word fun birthday message for my mum"
beats "Write something"

3

Iterate

Not perfect? Say "make it shorter", "add humour", or "use simpler words"

4

Give Context

The more background you share, the more tailored and useful the answer

Remember: Prompting is a skill. The more you practice, the better your results! 🚀